

PRIMULA

whorls of fragrant, tubular, bright yellow flowers. Ovate to spoon-shaped, toothed, mid-green leaves are sparsely covered with white farina. Cultivation group 6. Z9–11

P. ‘Lady Greer’ (illus. p.257). Semi-creeping, rosette-forming, semievergreen, Polyanthus Group primula. H and S 4–6in (10–15cm). Bears umbels of fragrant, funnel-shaped, creamy-yellow flowers in spring. Small, bright green leaves are produced close to the ground. Cultivation group 2. Z4–8

P. ‘Linda Pope’. See *P. marginata* ‘Linda Pope’.

P. malacoides. Erect, rosette-forming, evergreen perennial, usually grown as an annual. H 1–1½ft (30–45cm), S 8in (20cm). From winter to spring, small, flat, single or double, pale lilac-purple, reddish-pink and white flowers are borne in whorls of decreasing size up slender, softly hairy stems. Leaves are dainty, ovate, slightly frilly-margined, softly downy, and pale green. Cultivation group 6. Z10–11

P. ‘Margaret Martin’ (illus. p.259). Rosette-forming, Show Auricula primula. H 4in (10cm), S 6in (15cm). Bears flat, gray-edged flowers, with a black body color and white centers, in mid- to late spring. Has spoon-shaped, gray-green leaves covered with white farina. Excellent for exhibition. Cultivation group 4. Z4–8

P. marginata. Rosette-forming, semi-evergreen or evergreen perennial. H 6in (15cm), S 1ft (30cm). In spring, bears clusters of funnel-shaped, blue-lilac flowers above ovate, toothed, mid-green leaves densely covered with white farina. Cultivation group 4 or 5. Z4–8

‘Linda Pope’ (syn. *P.* ‘Linda Pope’) bears flat, mauve-blue flowers on short stems above ovate, toothed, mid-green leaves covered with white farina.

‘Prichard’s Variety’ has lilac-purple flowers with white eyes.

P. ‘Mark’ (illus. p.258). Vigorous, Alpine Auricula primula. H and S 4in (10cm). Produces flat, pink flowers, with light yellow centers, in spring. Has ovate, vibrant green leaves. Good for exhibition. Cultivation group 4. Z4–8

P. ‘Matthew Yates’ (illus. p.258). Vigorous, double Auricula primula. H and S 5in (12cm). Produces fully double, very dark bluish-red flowers in tight trusses in spring. Leaves are inversely ovate and mid-green with some farina. Good for exhibition. Cultivation group 1 or 4. Z4–8

P. melanops, syn. *P. chionantha* subsp. *melanops*. Rosette-forming perennial. H 14in (35cm), S 20in (50cm). In summer, bears umbels of pendent, narrowly funnel-shaped, deep violet-purple flowers, with black eyes, above strap-shaped, mid-green leaves. Cultivation group 2 or 4. Z4–8

P. ‘Miss Indigo’, syn. *P. vulgaris* ‘Miss Indigo’ (illus. p.258). Vigorous, rosette-forming, evergreen or semievergreen perennial. H 8in (20cm), S 14in (35cm). Has ovate to lance-shaped, toothed, bright green leaves. In spring, produces flat, double, deep rich purple flowers, with creamy-white tips. Cultivation group 2. Z4–8

P. modesta. Rosette-forming perennial. H and S 8in (20cm). Dense heads of small, tubular, pinkish-purple flowers are borne on short stems in spring. Rounded to ovate, mid-green leaves are covered with yellow farina. Cultivation group 1 or 4.

Z4–8. **var. *auriae***, H and S 2in (5cm), has yellow-eyed, pinkish-purple flowers and leaves covered with white farina.

P. ‘Moonstone’. Rosette-forming, border Auricula primula. H 5in (12cm), S 6in (15cm). Rounded, double, whitish- or greenish-yellow flowers are produced in profusion in spring. Leaves are ovate and mid-green. Preferably, grow under glass. Cultivation group 4 or 5. Z4–8

P. nana, syn. *P. edgeworthii*. Rosette-forming perennial. H 4in (10cm), S 6in (15cm). Flat, pale mauve flowers with white eyes are borne singly among ovate, toothed, pale green leaves in spring. Cultivation group 3 or 4. Z3–8

P. obconica. Erect, rosette-forming, evergreen perennial, usually grown as an annual. H 9–16in (23–40cm), S 10in (25cm). Flat, purple, lilac, or white flowers, with yellow eyes, are borne in dense umbels in winter–spring. Ovate, toothed, hairy leaves are pale green. Cultivation group 6. Z10–11

P. ‘Orb’. Neat, Show Auricula primula. H and S 4in (10cm). Has spoon-shaped, dark green leaves without farina. Bears flat, dark-green-edged flowers, each with a black body color and a central zone of white paste, from mid- to late spring. Good for exhibition. Cultivation group 4. Z4–8

P. palinuri (illus. p.259). Rosette-forming, evergreen perennial. H and S 1ft (30cm). One-sided clusters of semipendent, narrowly funnel-shaped, yellow flowers are borne on thick stems in early summer. Has rounded to ovate, lightly toothed, thick-textured, powdered, green leaves. Cultivation group 1 or 4; needs full sun. Z4–8

P. petiolaris. Rosette-forming, evergreen perennial. H 4in (10cm), S 8in (20cm). Tubular, purplish-pink flowers, with toothed petals, are borne singly in spring. Has small, ovate, toothed, mid-green leaves. Cultivation group 3 or 4. Z4–8

P. poissonii. Rosette-forming, evergreen perennial. H 18–20in (45–50cm), S 8–10in (20–25cm). Has long, inversely lance-shaped, dark green leaves. Produces 4–5 whorls of tubular, plum-purple flowers, with golden (rarely white) eyes in early and midsummer. Cultivation group 3. Z5–8

P. polyneura (illus. p.258). Rosette-forming perennial. H and S 1½ft (45cm). Dense heads of tubular, pale rose, rich rose or purple-rose flowers are produced in late spring or early summer. Rounded to ovate, shallowly lobed, downy, soft leaves are mid-green. Cultivation group 2. Z4–8

P. prolifera illus. p.445.

P. x pubescens. Vigorous, rosette-forming, evergreen perennial. H to 6in (15cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has obovate to broadly spoon-shaped, white-mealy, usually mid-green leaves. Flat umbels of flowers in white, yellow, pink, red, purple, or brown, are borne very freely in spring. Cultivation group 1 or 4. Z4–8.

‘Harlow Car’, H 3–4in (7–10cm), has shallowly toothed leaves and large, creamy-white flowers. **‘Mrs. J.H. Wilson’** is a rosette-forming, Alpine Auricula primula. H and S 4–6in (10–15cm). Has ovate, grayish-green leaves and small umbels of flat, white-centered, purple flowers.

P. pulverulenta (illus. p.258). Rosette-forming, Candelabra primula. H 3ft (90cm), S 2ft (60cm). In early summer, bears tubular, deep red flowers with purple-red eyes on stems covered with white farina. Has

broadly lance-shaped, toothed, coarse, mid-green leaves. Cultivation group 2. Z4–8.

Bartley Hybrids have flowers in shades from pale pink to purple, with darker eyes.

P. reidii. Robust, rosette-forming perennial. H 2–6in (5–15cm), S 4–6in (10–15cm). Produces dense clusters of bell-shaped, pure white flowers on slender stems in early summer. Has ovate, hairy, pale green leaves. Cultivation group 3 or 4. Z6–8. **var. *williamsii*** is more robust and has purplish-blue to pale blue flowers.

P. rosea. Rosette-forming perennial. H and S 8in (20cm). In early spring, bears small clusters of flat, glowing rose-pink flowers on short stems, amid ovate to lance-shaped, mid-green leaves, often bronze-flushed when young. Cultivation group 2. Z4–8

P. ‘Royal Velvet’. Vigorous, rosette-forming, Border Auricula primula. H and S 6–8in (15–20cm). Has large, spoon-shaped, pale green leaves. Flat, velvety, blue-tinged, maroon flowers, with frilled petals and large, creamy-yellow centers, are borne in spring. Cultivation group 2 or 5. Z4–5

P. secundiflora. Rosette-forming, semi-evergreen or evergreen perennial. H 2–3ft (60–90cm), S 2ft (60cm). In summer, bears clusters of pendent, funnel-shaped, reddish-purple flowers above lance-shaped, toothed leaves. Cultivation group 2. Z4–8

P. sieboldii (illus. p.258). Rosette-forming perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Umbels of flat, white, pink, or purple flowers, with white eyes, open above ovate, round-toothed, downy, soft, pale green leaves in early summer. Cultivation group 2. Z4–8. **‘Geisha Girl’** (illus. p.257) bears large, pink flowers with deeply cut petals.

P. sikkimensis (Himalayan cowslip; illus. p.259). Rosette-forming perennial. H 2–3ft (60–90cm), S 2ft (60cm). Pendent clusters of funnel-shaped, yellow flowers are borne in summer. Has rounded to ovate, toothed, pale green leaves. Cultivation group 2. Z4–8

P. sinensis. Erect, rosette-forming, evergreen perennial. H and S 6–8in (15–20cm). Flat, purple, purple-rose, pink, or white flowers, with yellow eyes, are borne in neat whorls in winter and early spring. Mid-green leaves are ovate, toothed, and hairy. Cultivation group 6. Z9–11

P. sonchifolia. Rosette-forming, deciduous perennial. H 2in (5cm), S 1ft (30cm). Produces dense umbels of tubular, blue-purple flowers with white eyes and yellow margins in spring. Leaves are ovate to lance-shaped, toothed, and mid-green. Cultivation group 3 or 4. Z4–8

P. Stella Series. Rosette-forming, evergreen to semievergreen, Polyanthus Group primulas. H to 1ft (30cm). Form sturdy, compact rosettes of ovate, heavily veined, dark green leaves. Upright stems bear flowers in a wide color range, including white, pink, red, yellow, orange, and deep purple, some with contrasting eyes. Cultivation group 1, 2, 4, or 6. Z4–8

P. ‘Tawny Port’. Very dwarf, rosette-forming, evergreen or semievergreen, Polyanthus Group primula. H 4–6in (10–15cm), S 6–8in (15–20cm). Bears flat, port-wine-colored flowers on short stems in spring. Rounded to ovate, toothed leaves are reddish-green. Cultivation group 1, 2, or 4. Z4–8

P. ‘Trouble’ (illus. p.259). Vigorous, Auricula. H and S 5in (12cm). Leaves are broad, inversely ovate, mid-green and

irregularly toothed. Fully double flowers, a blend of yellow and pink, result in pale coffee-colored blooms, borne in tight trusses in spring. Cultivation group 1 or 4. Z5–8

P. veris (Cowslip) illus. p.263. **‘Katy McSparrow’** (illus. p.259) is a rosette-forming, semievergreen perennial. H and S 10in (25cm). In mid- and late spring, bears fully double, deep golden-yellow flowers, each with an enlarged, grayish calyx, above tufts of long, sometimes scalloped, mid-green leaves. Z4–8

P. verticillata (illus. p.259). Rosette-forming perennial. H 8–10in (20–25cm), S 6–8in (15–20cm). Has ovate, toothed, mid-green leaves. Fragrant, bell-shaped, yellow flowers are borne in whorls in spring. Cultivation group 4 or 6. Z9–11

P. vialii (illus. p.257). Rosette-forming, often short-lived perennial. H 1–2ft (30–60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Dense, conical spikes of tubular, bluish-purple and red flowers are produced in late spring. Has lance-shaped, toothed, soft, mid-green leaves. Cultivation group 2. Z5–8

P. vulgaris (Primrose; illus. p.259). Rosette-forming, evergreen or semievergreen perennial. H 8in (20cm), S 14in (35cm). Flat, soft yellow flowers, with darker eyes, are borne singly among ovate to lance-shaped, toothed, bright green leaves in spring. Cultivation group 2. Z4–8.

‘Alba Plena’ (illus. p.257) has double, white flowers. **‘Gigha White’** see *P.* ‘Gigha’. **‘Lilacina Plena’** is vigorous and free-flowering, with fully double, lilac-purple flowers. **‘Miss Indigo’** see *P.* ‘Miss Indigo’. **subsp. *sibthorpii*** (illus. p.258) has pink or purplish-pink flowers.

P. ‘Wanda’. Vigorous, evergreen or semievergreen perennial. H 4–6in (10–15cm), S 12–16in (30–40cm). Has inversely lance-shaped to ovate, purplish-green foliage. In spring, has clusters of solitary, dark claret-red flowers. Thrives in sun or shade. Cultivation group 1 or 2. Z4–8

P. warshenewskiana. Rosette-forming perennial. H 3in (7cm), S 6in (15cm). Tiny, flat, white-eyed, bright pink flowers sit just above spoon-shaped, dark green leaves in early spring. Cultivation group 2 or 4. Divide clumps regularly in late winter before flowering. Z4–8

P. whitei ‘Sherriff’s Variety’. See *P. bhutanica* ‘Sherriff’s Variety’.

P. ‘Woodland Walk’ (illus. p.257) Rosette-forming, evergreen or semi-evergreen, Primrose Group primula. H and S 8in (20cm). Inversely ovate, wrinkled, dark green leaves are tinted with bronze. In late winter and spring, single stems bear flat flowers, from faintly pink-tinted white to vivid pink, with heart-shaped petals edged in darker pink. Cultivation group 2. Z5–9

P. ‘Yellow Dream’. Rosette-forming, Polyanthus Group primula. H and S 15–23cm (6–9in). Has ovate, toothed leaves. Bears large, fragrant, bright yellow flowers, with slightly darker yellow centers, in late winter and spring. Cultivation group 2. Z5–9

PRIMULINA

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of evergreen perennials or subshrubs, grown for their flowers. Frost tender. Requires well-drained soil, a fairly